JAMES MERCHANT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Mid-level DevOps engineer with 4 years of hands-on experience building and maintaining cloud infrastructure across AWS and Azure environments. I've spent most of my career automating deployment pipelines and reducing infrastructure costs through careful resource management. I enjoy solving infrastructure problems with code rather than manual processes, and I'm comfortable working across the full stack from containerisation to monitoring. Currently based in Birmingham, looking to take on more responsibility around infrastructure architecture.

WORK EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer

CloudScale Solutions Ltd

cloudscale.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented Kubernetes clusters using EKS, reducing deployment times from 45 minutes to 8 minutes across 12 microservices

Automated infrastructure provisioning using Terraform, managing over 200 AWS resources and reducing manual configuration errors by 95 percent

Built comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, decreasing mean time to detection for critical incidents from 20 minutes to 3 minutes

Mentored 2 junior engineers on containerisation best practices and led weekly infrastructure review sessions

Senior DevOps Technician

Nexus Digital Group

nexusdigital.co

Coventry, United Kingdom

July 2020 - February 2022

Managed CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitLab CI for 8 development teams, processing over 500 deployments per month with 99.2 percent success rate

Migrated legacy applications from on-premises servers to AWS, reducing monthly infrastructure costs by 40 percent and improving system availability to 99.9 percent

Implemented Infrastructure as Code practices using Ansible, reducing server setup time from 6 hours to 15 minutes

Developed custom Python monitoring scripts that identified and resolved performance bottlenecks affecting 3 production applications

DevOps Engineer

TechVenture Solutions Ltd

techventure.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

January 2019 - June 2020

Deployed and maintained Docker containerised applications across multiple environments, managing container orchestration for 25 microservices

Built automated backup and disaster recovery procedures using AWS S3 and cross-region replication, achieving RPO of 1 hour

Configured and maintained Apache and Nginx web servers, optimising configurations to handle 50,000 concurrent connections

Collaborated with development teams to troubleshoot production issues and implemented fixes that reduced application downtime by 60 percent

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services (EC2, S3, RDS, EKS, Lambda), Microsoft Azure (Virtual Machines, App Service)

Container and Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Compose, Amazon EKS

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation, Vagrant

CI/CD Tools: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, CircleCI

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, CloudWatch

Scripting Languages: Python, Bash, PowerShell

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Web Servers: Nginx, Apache

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, Amazon Linux), Windows Server

Networking: VPC configuration, Load Balancing, DNS, SSL/TLS

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/jmerchant-devops/terraform-aws-efs-setup

Complete Terraform modules for AWS EFS provisioning with monitoring and backup configuration

github.com/jmerchant-devops/kubernetes-cluster-automation

Production-ready Kubernetes deployment scripts with Helm charts and automated scaling policies

github.com/jmerchant-devops/python-infrastructure-monitor

Custom Python application for multi-cloud resource monitoring and cost analysis reporting

github.com/jmerchant-devops/docker-application-stack

Docker Compose configurations for common application stacks with load balancing and logging

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate - Amazon Web Services (2021)

Certified Kubernetes Administrator - Linux Foundation (2022)